conductors than for insulators. The resistivity of some commonly used materials is given in Table 4.2.

Table 4.2 Resistivity of some materials

NATURE OF THE MATERIAL	MATERIAL	RESISTIVITY (Ω m)
Conductor	Copper	1.62×10^{-8}
	Nickel	6.84×10^{-8}
	Chromium	12.9×10^{-8}
Insulator	Glass	10^{10} to 10^{14}
	Rubber	10^{13} to 10^{16}

Solved Problem-4

The resistance of a wire of length 10 m is 2 ohm. If the area of cross section of the wire is 2×10^{-7} m^2, determine its (i) resistivity (ii) conductance and (iii) conductivity

Solution:

Given: Length, L = 10 m, Resistance, R = 2 ohm and Area, A = 2×10^{-7} m^2

$$\text{Resistivity, } \rho = \frac{RA}{L} = \frac{2 \times 2 \times 10^{-7}}{10}$$

$$= 4 \times 10^{-8} \ \Omega \text{ m}$$

$$\text{Conductance, } \mathbf{G} = \frac{1}{R} = \frac{1}{2} = 0.5 \text{ mho}$$

$$\text{Conductivity, } \sigma = \frac{1}{\rho} = \frac{1}{4 \times 10^{-8}}$$

$$= 0.25 \times 10^{8} \text{ mho m}^{-1}$$

4.7 SYSTEM OF RESISTORS

So far, you have learnt how the resistance of a conductor affects the current through a circuit. You have also studied the case of the simple electric circuit containing a single resistor. Now in practice, you may encounter a complicated circuit, which uses a combination of many resistors. This combination of resistors is known as 'system of resistors' or 'grouping of resistors'. Resistors can be connected in various combinations. The two basic methods of joining resistors together are:

a) Resistors connected in series, and b) Resistors connected in parallel.

In the following sections, you shall compute the effective resistance when many resistors having different resistance values are connected in series and in parallel.

4.7.1 Resistors in series

A series circuit connects the components one after the other to form a 'single loop'. A series circuit has only one loop through which current can pass. If the circuit is interrupted at any point in the loop, no current can pass through the circuit and hence no electric appliances connected in the circuit will work. Series circuits are commonly used in devices such as flashlights. ***Thus, if resistors are connected end to end, so that the same current passes through each of them, then they are said to be connected in series***.

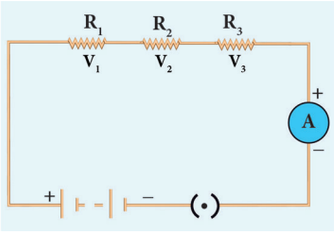


Figure 4.6 Series connection of resistors

Let, three resistances R_1, R_2 and R_3 be connected in series (Figure 4.6). Let the current flowing through them be I. According to Ohm's Law, the potential differences V_1, V_2 and V_3 across R_1, R_2 and R_3 respectively, are given by:

$$V_1 = I R_1 \quad (4.7)$$

$$V_2 = I R_2 \quad (4.8)$$

$$V_3 = I R_3 \quad (4.9)$$

The sum of the potential differences across the ends of each resistor is given by:

$$V = V_1 + V_2 + V_3$$

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